

I did not go to the market on Monday; Bauji and Ma insisted that I take the day off and be with them that day. I tried talking them out of it, but later yielded to their request, seeing that my presence at home would calm them down a little. They were more shaken by the incident than I was.

The Sensex rose around 100 points in the first two trading sessions of the week. In all likelihood, the government had directed domestic institutions to buffer any panic selling. But the rally fizzled out, and by the end of the March the Sensex was slightly below where it stood before the blasts happened. Still, the market took the blasts in its stride and chose to focus on the positive developments in the economy resulting from policy reforms.

As for me, I preferred to play the IPOs through the thriving grey market in these issues. The grey market, as it was called, was an illegal market for trading in IPOs before they were listed on the stock exchanges. Back then, it took nearly two to two and a half months for an issue to get listed on the stock exchange after the subscription period. In the intervening period, there was money to be made . . . or lost.